KALI LINUX LAB SETUP

Week 1 – Project Module 1
VMware Workstation on Windows 11

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Platform	Windows 11, VMware Workstation and Kali Linux
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Introduction

The aim of this work was to prepare a Kali Linux virtual machine for cybersecurity practice. I used VMware Workstation on my Windows 11 computer. During the setup, I checked the network connection, enabled a shared folder, tested file access from Kali, enabled clipboard sharing, and created a snapshot.

I followed the lab instructions as closely as possible using VMware. Some network details differ from the original PDF, which asks for VirtualBox and the 10.0.0.0/24 network. These differences are listed near the end of this report.

1. Network Check

I opened the Kali terminal and ran the following commands:

```
ip -br address
ip route
```

The output showed that the **eth0** interface was up. Its IP address was **192.168.10.129/24**, and the default gateway was **192.168.10.2**. I then tested internet connectivity with ping commands. All three tests replied successfully, as confirmed during the setup.

2. Shared Folder Setup

In VMware, I enabled the shared folder named **CyberLab-Shared**. At first, Kali did not have the `/mnt/hgfs` directory, so I created it and checked whether the VMware share was available.

```
mkdir -p /mnt/hgfs
vmware-hgfsclient
```

The share name appeared in the output. I then mounted it with this command:

```
vmhgfs-fuse .host:/ /mnt/hgfs -o allow_other
```

After mounting, the folder appeared at `/mnt/hgfs/CyberLab-Shared`.

3. File Sharing Test

To check that Kali could access the share, I created a small text file and read it back:

```
echo "VMware file sharing works" > /mnt/hgfs/CyberLab-Shared/test.txt
cat /mnt/hgfs/CyberLab-Shared/test.txt
```

The file displayed the text “VMware file sharing works”. This confirms that the file could be created and read from Kali. I should also check the Windows host folder to confirm that the same file is visible there.

4. Clipboard and Drag-and-Drop

I opened the virtual machine settings in VMware and enabled the Guest Isolation options for copy and paste and drag and drop. I tested copy and paste between Windows and Kali, and it worked.

5. Snapshot

After finishing the main setup steps, I shut down Kali and opened VMware Snapshot Manager. I created a snapshot with the following details:

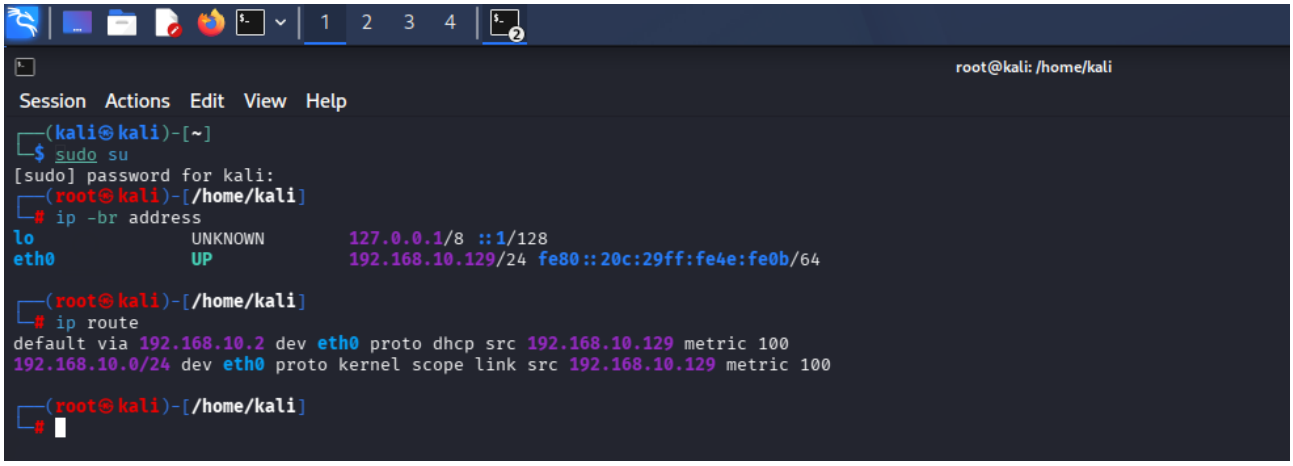
Name: Kali-Linux-Lab-Setup-Complete
Description: Kali Linux lab setup completed. NAT internet connectivity verified, VMware shared folder tested, and clipboard sharing enabled.

The Snapshot Manager showed the new snapshot, and the VM was powered off at the time of the screenshot. The snapshot will be useful if I need to return to this setup later.

6. Screenshots

The screenshots below are evidence collected during the setup process.

Screenshot 1 – Network information



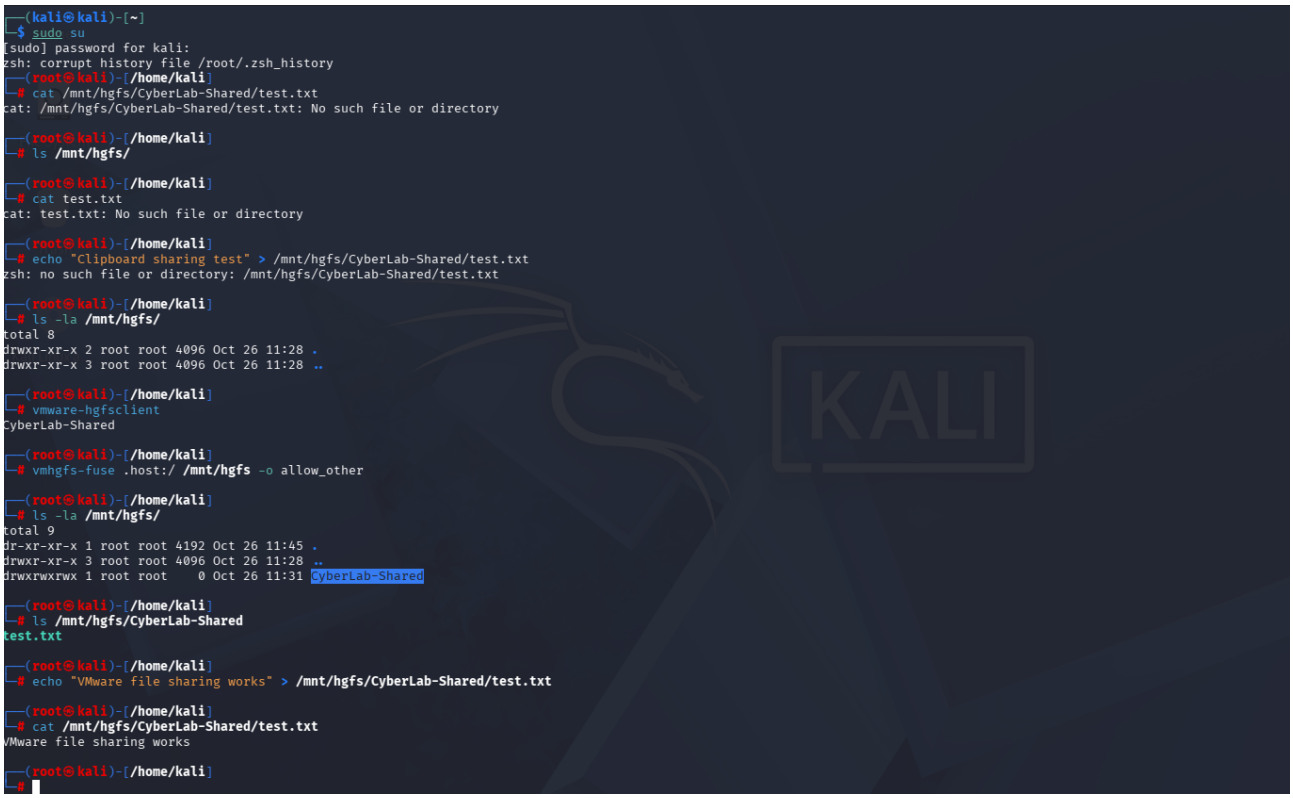
The terminal output shows eth0 with IP address 192.168.10.129/24 and the default route via 192.168.10.2.

Screenshot 2 – Shared folder mounted



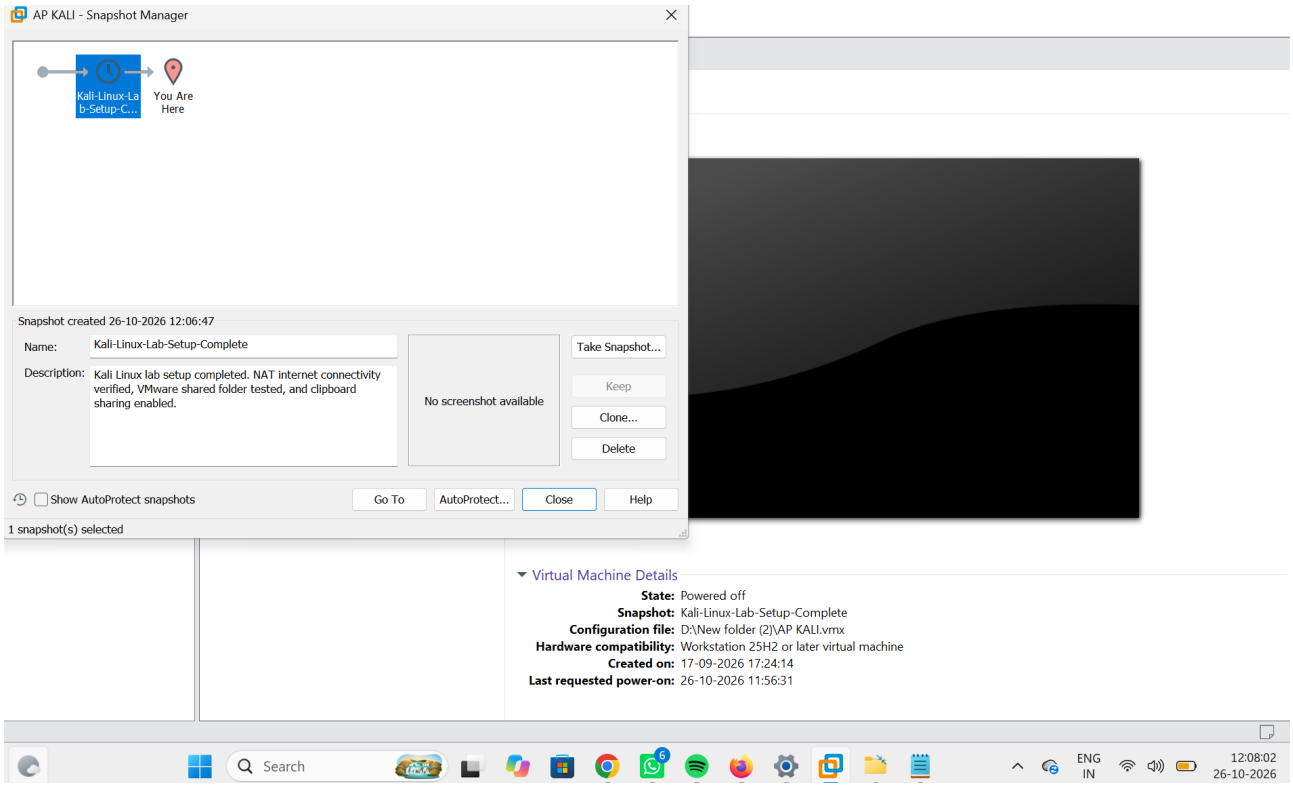
The share is listed by vmware-hgfsclient and appears under /mnt/hgfs after mounting.

Screenshot 3 – File-sharing test



The test.txt file is present in the shared folder and its contents are displayed in the terminal.

Screenshot 4 – Snapshot Manager



The snapshot Kali-Linux-Lab-Setup-Complete is visible in VMware Snapshot Manager.

7. Comparison with the Assignment

Assignment requirement	Current result	Status
Use VirtualBox	VMware Workstation used instead	Different platform
NAT Network: 10.0.0.0/24	Current network: 192.168.10.0/24	Needs adjustment if exact subnet is required
Kali IP: 10.0.0.2/24	Observed IP: 192.168.10.129/24	Does not match yet
Share host Downloads folder	CyberLab-Shared configured	Folder name/path differs
Clipboard and drag/drop	Enabled; copy/paste tested	Completed by user confirmation
Internet access	Ping tests reported successful	Completed by user confirmation
Create a snapshot	Snapshot created	Completed

8. Conclusion and Remaining Checks

The main VMware lab setup steps I worked on are complete. Kali has a working network configuration, internet access was confirmed, the shared folder can be mounted, a test file was read successfully, clipboard sharing works, and the snapshot has been saved.

Before submitting, I will check whether my instructor accepts VMware in place of VirtualBox. If the assignment must match the PDF exactly, I still need to configure the 10.0.0.0/24 network and Kali IP 10.0.0.2/24, and use the host Downloads folder as the share. I will make those changes carefully and keep the current snapshot as a recovery point.

This report records the steps completed and the results observed. Internet and clipboard results were confirmed during the setup, but separate screenshots of those tests were not provided for this report.